Important Note: The experiment supporting this research was approved by the Ethics Committee, Department of Computer Science and Technology, University of Cambridge, and by the Ethics Commission of the Faculty of Science, University of Porto.

Note2: The campaigns are now finished. A huge thank you to all participants and all of those who have shown interest in participating but that didn't had the chance. This page will be kept as his for the sole purpose of demonstrating how the data was collected.

COP-MODE Campaigns

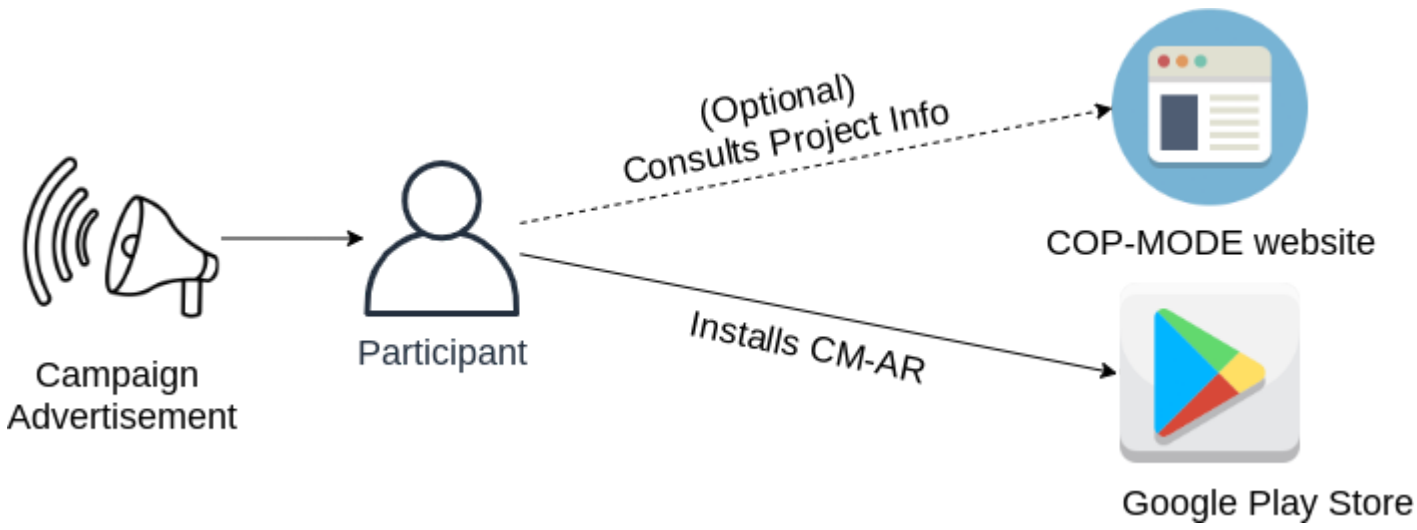
In order to develop our privacy manager, we will first collect some data. Several campaigns will be ran with volunteers that are willing to contribute to the project. Participants will be rewarded with a gift card at the end of the campaign.

Requirements: the participant should be at least 18 years old to participate in a COP-MODE campaign and an Android user.

Campaign Methodology

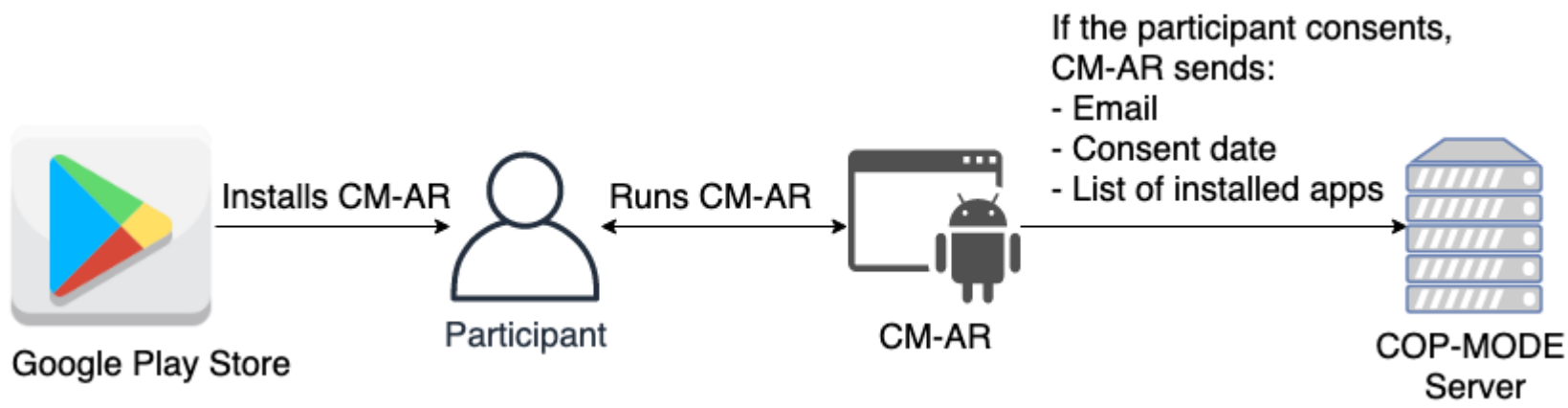
COP-MODE's campaigns consist of 5 iterative steps as illustrated in the following video and further detailed next. For any clarification or further information, feel free to contact us.

Step #1: Recruitment



The first step starts with the recruitment of participants. For this purpose, the COP-MODE team shall advertise the opening of a campaign through an email list, for example. A potential participant shall then download and install COP-MODE Apps Retriever (CM-AR) through the Play Store.

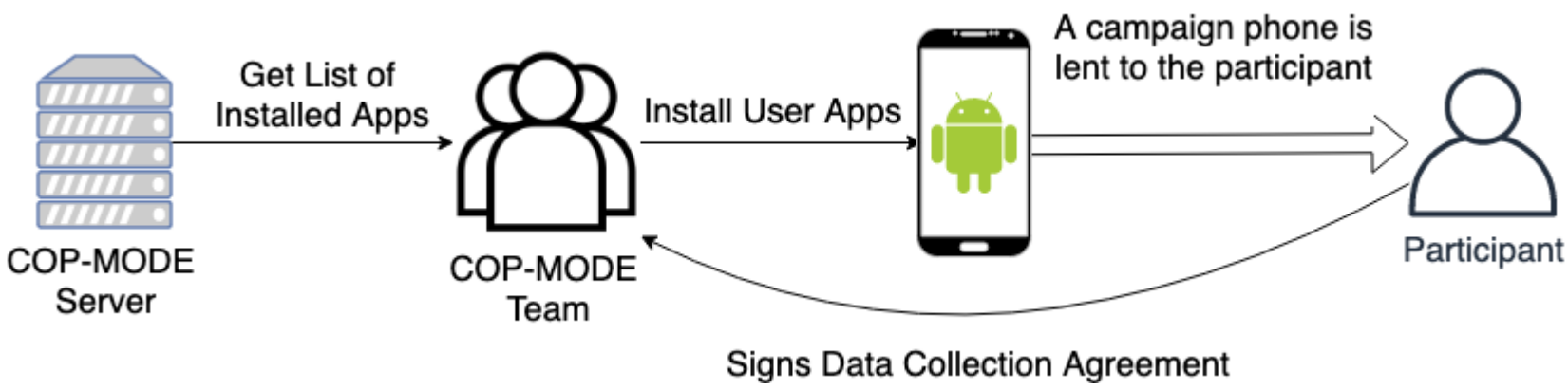
Step #2: Running CM-AR



After downloading CM-AR from the Play Store, the participant shall run the app while following its instructions. CM-AR will send the participant's email and the list of installed apps (and repesctive permissions) to our server. **Note** that by list of apps we refer to the name of each installed apps, that is, no other data or information belonging to the apps is collected. For instance, we collect that the participant has the application WhatsApp installed, but we don't have access to its messages or its contacts.

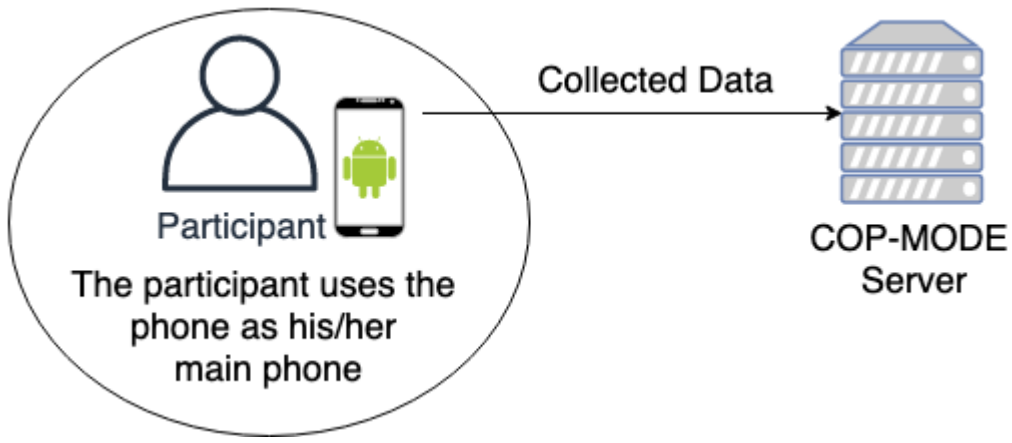
The participant's email is collected only as communication medium for the duration of the campaign. At the end of the campaign we delete all emails such that the data is anonymized. The list of apps is used by the COP-MODE team to install them in a campaign's smartphone that is then lent to the participant for the duration of the campaign (see step #3). Thus, the campaign smartphone will come pre-installed with the participant's personal apps.

Step #3: Smartphone Setup And Lent



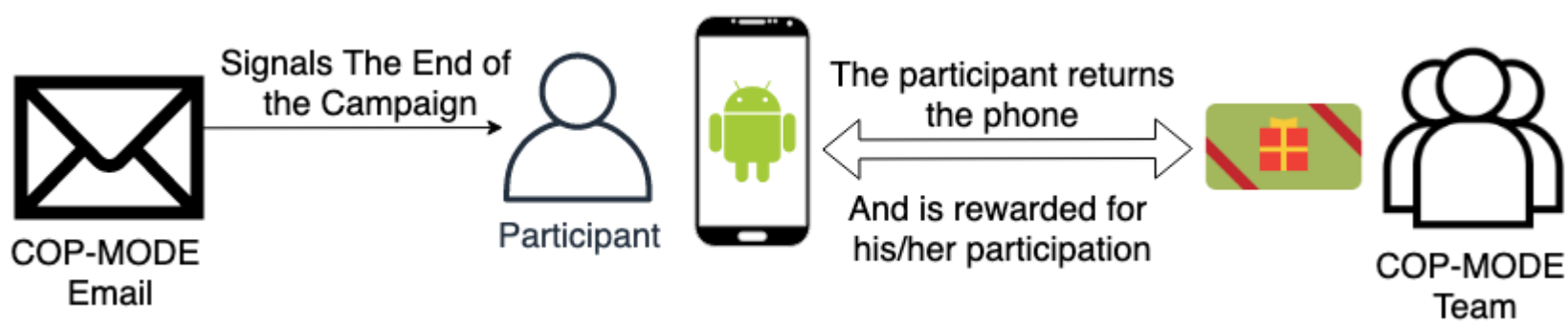
As referred in step #2, after sending the list of apps to the server, the COP-MODE team will install these apps in a campaign's smartphone. This smartphone will additionally have pre-installed COP-MODE Naive Permission Manager (CM-NPM), a permission manager that will prompt the participant apps' permission requests. CM-NPM will additionally collect and send the data for/to the COP-MODE server. An email will be sent to the participant to pick up the smartphone and when receiving the device, the participant shall sign our data collection agreement.

Step #4: Data Collection (1 week)



For the period of one week, the participant shall use the campaign smartphone as his main personal phone. Throughout this period, the permission manager CM-NPM will prompt to user to whether allow or deny apps' accesses to resources. The participant's responses to this prompts will be collected as well as both user and device contextual data.

Step #5: Campaign Ends (after 1 week)



After the data collection period, the participant shall receive an email from the COP-MODE team, signaling the end of the campaign. The participant shall then return the smartphone and get his voucher as reward for his participation.

Note: The voucher reward is contingent to the use of the campaign device as the primary smartphone for the duration of the data collection phase. Participants that fail to regularly use the campaign smartphone will be disqualified.

Data Collected Throughout a Campaign

In order to develop a privacy manager that is automatic, context-aware and personalized, we need to to collect individual privacy choices and the context surrounding those choices at the time they are made.

In the context of a smartphone, privacy decisions can be summarized to the choice of either allowing or denying an application from accessing a resource (such as location). As for the context, we will collect data on the state of the device, such as applications running in the foreground and background, and on the context of the participant. The context of the participant is defined as any piece of data that describes his current situation, environment and activity. This definition includes data such as the participant location and the people in vicinity.

The full list of the data types that we collect is described in point B of our data collection agreement. This agreement should be read, understood and signed by all participants, just as described in step #3 of the campaign operations.

COP-MODE

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Contact

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